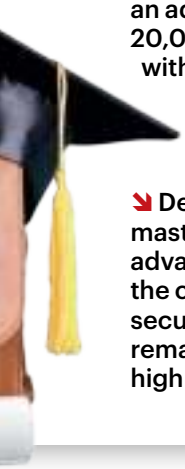
H-1B VISA

- The H-1B visa allows US employers to hire foreign workers in specialty occupations
- Many Indian students transition from OPT to H-1B status

VISA CAP

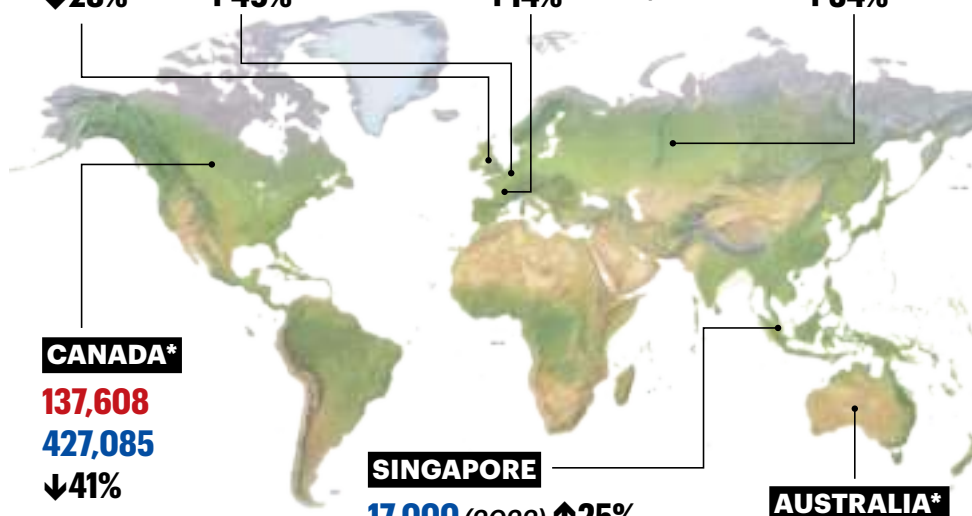
- 85,000 visas annually, including 65,000 for general applicants and an additional 20,000 for those with advanced degrees from US institutions
- Despite the master's cap advantage, the chances of securing a visa remain low due to high demand



WHERE ELSE THEY CAN GO

Over the decades, an American education has gained favour among Indians. While the UK has been another traditional destination, other countries like Canada, Australia, Singapore and Germany have been attracting more Indian students

NUMBER OF STUDENTS
- 2024
- 2023
- ↓↑Change



UK
98,890
136,921
↓28%

GERMANY
34,702
23,296
↑49%

FRANCE
8,536
7,484
↑14%

*France aims to increase numbers to **30,000** by 2030*

RUSSIA
31,444
23,503
↑34%

CANADA*
137,608
427,085
↓41%

**These figures are for fresh enrolments only*

SINGAPORE
17,000 *(2022)* ↑25%
There has been a significant uptick in Indian student enrolments, with a reported 25% year-on-year growth

AUSTRALIA*
68,572
78,093
↓12%

Source: Union Ministry of Education

A GLIMMER OF HOPE

Even as the clouds of uncertainty hover, many see it as a temporary reset rather than a permanent barrier for the world's best and brightest. Vibha Kagzi, a Harvard alumna and founder of foreign education consultancy Reachivy.com, believes the "American dream" is merely being recalibrated, not extinguished. "Historically, policy shifts in international education have corrected themselves, especially with strong pushback from universities, industry leaders and lawmakers who value global talent," she says. She also believes the US still offers unmatched advantages in scale, research funding, alumni networks and global reputation.

Akshay Chaturvedi of study abroad platform Leverage Edu, thinks likewise. "This isn't a shutdown," he says, "but a systemic reset in how the US engages with global talent. America has always bounced back, and these cyclical shifts often create more inclusive and outcome-focused systems."

Many see the current policy as a reset, not a permanent barrier to the best talent entering the US, which it will still need for highly skilled jobs like data analysis

Shukla believes top-tier universities will remain largely unaffected. "The crackdown seems aimed at filtering those who misuse admissions at obscure institutions just to settle in the US," he says. "For highly skilled roles, like data analysis or cybersecurity, US still needs international talent."

There are also those who think the new vetting process of international student visas will improve immigration screening. University Living founder and CEO Saurabh Arora says, "Scrutiny of social media handles, email addresses and phone numbers from applicants over the past five years will better verify identities, prevent fraud and ensure a safe environment for living in the US." Aman Singh of GradRight, an agency that guides students on finding suitable colleges and funding, believes legitimate applications will continue to be processed. "Students actively stoking anti-US sentiment may face trouble, and new vetting steps could slow decisions," he